

MK PARRISH · MKPARRISH.COM

THE CLEAN RESUME TEMPLATE



An ATS-safe, human-readable resume layout with prompts built into every section.

BY MK PARRISH · \$12

WHY THIS EXISTS

The best resume design is quiet.

It does not hide the work behind columns, icons, tiny type, or decorative lines that confuse applicant tracking systems. It gives the reader the proof fast. A recruiter is not trying to admire the page. They are trying to decide whether to keep reading.

This template gives you a clean structure and the prompts to fill it well.

“

Make the page easy to scan. Make the proof hard to dismiss.

Use the template first. Then use the examples to sharpen the language.

THE TEMPLATE

Copy this structure into your document editor.

FIRST LAST

City, State or Remote | Email | Phone | LinkedIn | Portfolio

TARGET ROLE / PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY

One or two lines that explain who you are, what you do, and the context or context that matters most for the role you want.

CORE STRENGTHS

Strength 1 | Strength 2 | Strength 3 | Strength 4 | Strength 5

EXPERIENCE

ROLE TITLE

Company | Location or Remote | Month Year - Month Year

One-line context if the company, team, or scope needs it

- Built / led / improved [thing] for [scope], resulting in [result]

- Rebuilt / simplified / created [system or process]
- Partnered with [stakeholders] to [action], improv

ROLE TITLE

Company | Location or Remote | Month Year - Month Year

- [Strongest proof first.]
- [Scope, ownership, or complexity.]
- [Collaboration, systems, judgment, or execution.]

EDUCATION

Degree or Credential | School | Year

TOOLS / SKILLS

Category: skill, skill, skill

Category: skill, skill, skill



HEADER RULES

Keep the header simple and searchable.

Use:

- Name
- City/state or "Remote"
- Email
- Phone
- LinkedIn
- Portfolio, if relevant

Skip:

- Full mailing address
- Icons
- Headshot
- Decorative monograms
- Multiple phone numbers
- Quotes in the header

Your name can be larger. Everything else should be boring on purpose.

SUMMARY FORMULA

Use one of these.

Formula A - Career pivot

[ROLE / IDENTITY] with a background in [PAST FIELD] and strength in [SKILL / QUALITY]
Known for [OUTCOME / EDGE]. Moving toward [TARGET ROLE]



Example:

Operations-minded project manager with a background in hospital administration
Known for turning moving parts into calm systems people can rely on

client operations roles where speed, communication, and problem-solving are key



Formula B - Senior operator

[ROLE] with [YEARS]+ years in [CONTEXT]. Strongest in [PROBLEM] with a record of [PROOF / OUTCOME].

Example:

Marketing operations lead with 8+ years in B2B SaaS and founder. Strongest in messy handoffs, campaign systems, and repeatable of turning scattered processes into repeatable revenue.

Formula C - Creative or strategist

[ROLE] who helps [AUDIENCE / TEAM] [OUTCOME] through [METHOD / EXPERIENCE]. Experienced across [CONTEXTS] with strength in [SKILLS].

Example:

Brand strategist who helps early-stage founders turn vague ideas into products that people can understand and buy. Experienced across web and mobile.

with strength in voice, positioning, and proof.



BULLET RULES

Good bullets have weight. They are not job descriptions copied from HR.

Use this pattern:

Strong verb + thing you owned + scope + result.

Strong bullet examples

- Built a client onboarding tracker in Airtable that gave sales, delivery, and leadership one shared source of truth.
- Led weekly campaign operations across email, paid social, and sales enablement for a four-person marketing team.
- Rewrote internal reporting into a one-page dashboard used by leadership to spot blocked revenue and delayed launches.
- Coordinated 30+ vendor, client, and internal stakeholders across a six-week production timeline with no missed delivery dates.
- Simplified the intake process from six disconnected forms into one workflow, reducing duplicate requests and manual follow-up.

Weak words to replace

Replace:

- Responsible for
- Helped with

- Assisted in
- Worked on
- Handled
- Involved in

With:

- Owned
- Built
- Led
- Supported
- Coordinated
- Improved
- Rebuilt
- Launched
- Managed
- Simplified
- Translated

If "assisted" is true, be specific about your piece of the work. Supporting work still has value when the scope is clear.

ONE-PAGE LAYOUT RULES

Use these settings unless your industry expects something else.

- Font: 10.5 to 11.5 pt for body text
- Margins: 0.5 to 0.75 inches
- Name: 18 to 24 pt
- Section headers: bold, all caps, simple
- Dates: right aligned or same line, but consistent
- Bullets: 2 to 5 per role
- File format: PDF for sending, DOCX only when requested

Avoid:

- Two-column layouts
- Text boxes
- Tables
- Icons
- Skill bars
- Photos
- Tiny gray type
- Decorative script fonts

Clean does not mean plain. Clean means the reader does not have to fight the page.

THE TEN-SECOND SCAN

Before sending, give yourself ten seconds and answer:

- What role is this person aiming for?
- What are they clearly good at?
- What is the strongest proof on the page?
- Does the top third make me want to keep reading?
- Can I find their contact information immediately?

If you cannot answer those quickly, the page is not clean yet.

FINAL EXPORT CHECKLIST

- [] Saved as `First-Last-Resume.pdf`
- [] Links tested
- [] No icons or layout elements that might break parsing
- [] Same date format throughout
- [] Same punctuation style throughout
- [] Strongest role bullets appear first
- [] Summary points toward the target role
- [] Skills are grouped and relevant
- [] One page if possible, two pages only if the proof earns it

The goal is not to look impressive. The goal is to make the truth legible.

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